

SONG JOURNEY

"Sweet Child O' Mine"

Guns N' Roses

Thread song — it grows through Modules 1–5, with a Module 7 finale

One song, five layers. Each module adds a new tool to this song. Layer 6 is a bonus — the famous intro riff.

Verse chords	D · C · G
Chorus chords	A · C · D
Rhythm	Verse: 2 bars per chord. Chorus: 1 bar per chord.
Tempo	Practice at 60 BPM. The record is tuned a half-step lower — your version sounding slightly higher is normal.

LAYER 1 Listen

Module 1

The intro is played one note at a time — no chords, no strumming — and it's still instantly recognizable. Listen for how the single-note riff sketches the chords underneath the band.

Play it: Listen to the first minute.
Count how many times the intro riff repeats before the vocals start.
Notice the moment the drums arrive.

You've got it when: You can hum the main hook from memory.

Level up

Listen once more. Find where the guitar solo starts.
What changes? _____

LAYER 2 Bass Roots

Module 2

Three notes on the two lowest strings carry the whole verse — the root of each chord, one every two bars. This is the song stripped down to its simplest notes, and it still works.

Verse bass roots · low E & A strings · one note per 2 bars

	D	D	C	C	G	G	D	D (loop)
e	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
A	--5-----	--5-----	--3-----	--3-----	-----	-----	--5-----	--5-----
E	-----	-----	-----	-----	--3-----	--3-----	-----	-----

Play it: One note every 2 bars at 60 BPM.
Strike it on beat 1 of each bar.
Say the note names out loud: D, C, G.

You've got it when: You can play it from memory at 60 BPM, no stops.

Level up

Play each root once per beat — 8 times across the 2 bars — instead of letting it ring.

Level up · one root note per beat · verse loop

	D	D	C	C
e	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	-----	-----	-----	-----
A	--5--5--5--5--	--5--5--5--5--	--3--3--3--3--	--3--3--3--3--
E	-----	-----	-----	-----

	G	G	D	D (loop)
e	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	-----	-----	-----	-----
A	-----	-----	--5--5--5--5--	--5--5--5--5--
E	--3--3--3--3--	--3--3--3--3--	-----	-----

LAYER 3 Power Chords

Module 3

Same three roots from Layer 2 — each note now also plays the note a fifth above it. This layer covers the whole song: the verse loop, the chorus that answers it twice as fast, and the outro run at the end of the record.

Verse power chords · 2 bars per chord · 60 BPM

	D5	D5	C5	C5	G5	G5	D5	D5 (loop)
e	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	--7-----	--7-----	--5-----	--5-----	-----	-----	--7-----	--7-----
A	--5-----	--5-----	--3-----	--3-----	--5-----	--5-----	--5-----	--5-----
E	-----	-----	-----	-----	--3-----	--3-----	-----	-----

Play it: Hold each chord 8 beats (2 bars) at 60 BPM.

Play 4 clean laps, both strings ringing.

Chorus power chords · 1 bar per chord · 60 BPM

	A5	C5	D5 (loop)
e	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----
D	--2-----	--5-----	--7-----
A	--0-----	--3-----	--5-----
E	-----	-----	-----

Play it: Play 1 bar per chord at 60 BPM.

Slide the same 2-finger shape up the neck: A5 to C5 to D5.

Land the shift right on beat 1 of each new bar.

Outro power-chord slide · about 1 bar per chord · 60 BPM

	E5	G5	A5	C5	D5 (loop)
e	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
A	--2-----	--5-----	--7-----	--10-----	--12-----
E	--0-----	--3-----	--5-----	--8-----	--10-----

Play it: Play about 1 bar per chord at 60 BPM.

Slide one shape down the low E string through all 5 chords.

You've got it when: The loop runs at 60 BPM, every string ringing clean, no stops.

Level up

Palm-mute the verse power chords. Then play 1 loud lap with the chords ringing.

Level up · palm-muted verse

	D5	D5	C5	C5	G5	G5	D5	D5 (loop)
e	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	--7-----	--7-----	--5-----	--5-----	-----	-----	--7-----	--7-----
A	--5-----	--5-----	--3-----	--3-----	--5-----	--5-----	--5-----	--5-----
E	-----	-----	-----	-----	--3-----	--3-----	-----	-----
PM	_____							

LAYER 4 Pentatonic Solo

Module 4

The famous outro solo lives in E minor pentatonic. You know the open-position box — the block of frets where the pattern sits — and the same shape sits one octave up at fret 12.

4 rungs. Climb them in order.

Rung 1 · Rule of 3 — start here**Open position · full box (E · G · A · B · D)**

e	--0-----3-----
B	--0-----3-----
G	--0-----2-----
D	--0-----2-----
A	--0-----2-----
E	--0-----3-----

Fret 12 box · same shape, one octave up

e	--12-----15-----
B	--12-----15-----
G	--12-----14-----
D	--12-----14-----
A	--12-----14-----
E	--12-----15-----

Play it: Improvise 4 bars in the open position.

Then 4 more at fret 12 — same pattern, one octave up.

Leave space between phrases. Land on E.

Rung 2 · The two-octave climb

1. Climb the open box from the low E string to the high e string.
2. Make the exact same climb at fret 12.
3. Connect them: climb the open box, jump to fret 12, and keep climbing without stopping — one run, 2 octaves.

The climb · E minor pentatonic, open position (then repeat at fret 12)

```

e |-----0---3-|
B |-----0---3-|
G |-----0---2-|
D |-----0---2-|
A |-----0---2-|
E |--0---3-----|

```

Rung 3 · Hammer-ons and slides

1. Hammer-on (h): pick the first note, then tap the higher fret hard with your ring finger — two notes, one pick.
2. Slide (/): pick once, keep pressing, glide up.

Hammer-ons and slides · h = hammer-on · / = slide · fret-12 box

```

      D   E       G   A       D   E       E
e |-----|-----|-----|
B |-----|-----|-----|
G |-----12h14-----|-----|
D |--12h14-----|--12/14-----14-----|
A |-----|-----|-----|
E |-----|-----|-----|

```

Play it: Practice each move slowly until the second note sounds clearly.
Add them to your Rung 1 phrases.

Rung 4 · 2 outro-solo licks

2 licks (short solo phrases) from the same box to start your solos.

Lick 1 · down and back up · lands on E

```

      G       E       D       E
e |--15-----12-----12-|
B |-----15-----|
G |-----|
D |-----|
A |-----|
E |-----|

```

Lick 2 · ascending · lands on E

```

      A       B       D       E
e |-----|
B |-----|
G |-----|
D |-----12-----14-|
A |--12-----14-----|
E |-----|

```

Play it: Learn each lick exactly.
Then change one note, or change the rhythm.

You've got it when: You've climbed all 4 rungs — dress-ups and licks in your solos.

Level up

Slide from the open box to the fret 12 box in the middle of a phrase.

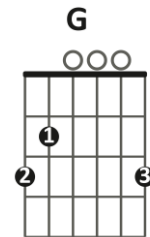
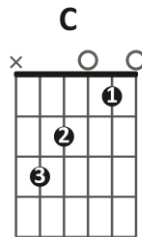
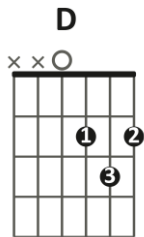
Level up · slide between the two boxes · 2 bars

	E	A	A/A	E	A	E
e	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----12-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----2-----	2/14--	-----	-----14-----	-----	-----
D	--2-----	-----	--14-----	-----	-----	-----
A	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
E	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----

LAYER 5 Open Chords

Module 5

The simple singalong version. The verse loop becomes 3 open chords you can strum and sing over — the whole song from just D, C, and G.

**Verse loop · 2 bars per chord · 60 BPM**

D	D	C	C	
1 2 3 4	1 2 3 4	1 2 3 4	1 2 3 4	
G	G	D	D	(loop)
1 2 3 4	1 2 3 4	1 2 3 4	1 2 3 4	

Play it: Play down-strums, 2 bars per chord: 4 strums, then 4 more.

One full verse loop with every change landing on beat 1.

You've got it when: The full loop runs at 60 BPM with every change on the beat.

Level up

Folk strum on every chord: D D U U D U.

Level up · folk strum · one bar per chord

D	C
1 2 & 3 & 4 &	1 2 & 3 & 4 &
D D U U D U	D D U U D U
G	D
1 2 & 3 & 4 &	1 2 & 3 & 4 &
D D U U D U	D D U U D U

LAYER 6 The Intro Riff

Bonus

Bonus layer — optional harder challenge, no score. Best once Layer 4's fret-12 box feels automatic.

Play the intro riff slowly, one note per beat. The picking hand moves; the fretting hand barely moves.

Intro riff · one note per beat · loops over the D bar · 60 BPM

	D	D	A	G	G	A	F#	A
e	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----15-----	-----14-----	-----	-----
B	-----15-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----14-----	-----12-----	-----	-----	-----14-----	-----14-----	-----	-----
D	-----12-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
A	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
E	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----

Play it: Play 1 note per beat at 60 BPM.

Play bar 1: D, high D, A, G.

Play bar 2: high G, A, F#, A.

You've got it when: You can loop the riff cleanly at 60 BPM, no buzzing.

Level up

Loop the riff twice, then land on a big D5 power chord.

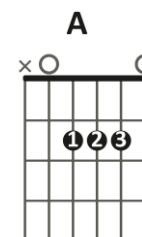
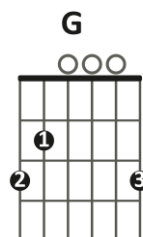
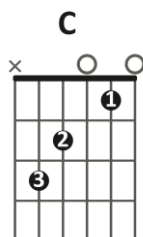
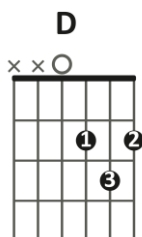
Or play it while a partner strums the Layer 5 verse loop.

Level up · D5 ending · 1 bar

	D5
e	-----
B	-----
G	-----
D	-----7-----
A	-----5-----
E	-----

FULL CHORD CHART**"Sweet Child O' Mine"**

Guns N' Roses

Tempo 125 BPM**Rhythm** Verse: two bars per chord. Chorus and outro: about one bar per chord.**Shapes you need****INTRO RIFF**

| D | D |

The famous riff loops over the D bar (Bonus layer). Strummers hold D.

VERSE

| D | D | C | C | G | G | D | D |

Repeat the 8 bars until the chorus.

CHORUS

| A5 | C5 | D5 | A5 | C5 | D5 |

A5 · C5 · D5 loop. Moves twice as fast as the verse.

VERSE

| D | D | C | C | G | G | D | D |

Same as the first verse.

CHORUS

| A5 | C5 | D5 | A5 | C5 | D5 |

Same as the first chorus.

GUITAR SOLO

Listen to the record and follow it.

OUTRO

| E5 | G5 | A5 | C5 | D5 |

"Where do we go now" — repeat the five bars to the end. About one bar each.

Teaching chart — simplified to match the Journey layers, not a note-for-note transcription. Chord names are what the class plays in standard tuning.

Sweet Child O Mine Chords by Guns N' Roses

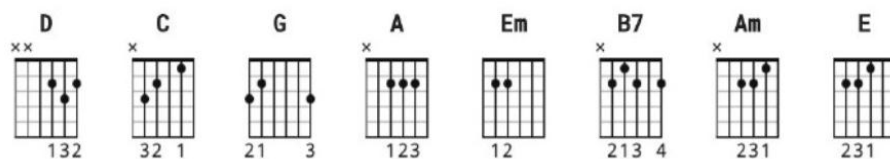


Difficulty: beginner

Tuning: Eb Ab Db Gb Bb Eb

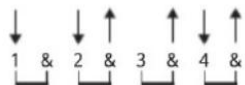
Key: D

CHORDS



STRUMMING PATTERN

125 bpm



(Guitar Tuning: Eb, Ab, Db, Gb, Bb, eb or the equivalent with sharps)

[Intro]

D	D	C	C	G	G	D	D	
D	D	C	C	G	G	D	D	
D	D	C	C	G	G	D	D	

[Verse 1]

D
She's got a smile that it seems to me
C
Reminds me of childhood memories
G
Where everything
D
Was as fresh as a bright blue sky
D
Now and then when I see her face
C
She takes me away to that special place
G
And if I stared too long
D
I'd probably break down and cry

[Chorus]

A **C** **D**
Whoa oh, oh, sweet child o' mine
A **C** **D**
Whoa, oh, oh, oh sweet love o' mine

[Instrumental]

| **D** | **D** | **C** | **C** | **G** | **G** | **D** | **D** |

[Verse 2]

D
She's got eyes of the bluest skies
C
As if they thought of rain
G
I'd hate to look into those eyes
D
And see an ounce of pain
D
Her hair reminds me of a warm safe place
C
Where as a child I'd hide
G
And pray for the thunder and rain
D
To quietly pass me by

[Chorus]

A **C** **D**
Whoa oh, oh, sweet child o' mine
A **C** **D**
Whoa, oh, oh, oh sweet love o' mine

[Instrumental]

| **D** | **D** | **C** | **C** | **G** | **G** | **D** | **D** |
| **D** | **D** | **C** | **C** | **G** | **G** | **D** | **D** |

[Chorus]

A **C** **D**
 Whoa oh, oh, oh sweet child o' mine
A **C** **D**
 Whoa, oh, oh, oh sweet love o' mine
A **C** **D**
 Whoa oh, oh, oh sweet child o' mine, ooh, yea-eah
A **C** **D**
 Ooooooooooh, sweet love o' mine

[Solo Part 1]

Em	C	B7	Am	
Em	C	B7	Am	
Em	C	B7	Am	
Em	C	B7	Am	Am

[Solo Part 2]

Em	G	A	C D G	
Em	G	A	C D G	
Em	G	A	C D G	
Em	G	A	C D G	

[Outro]

Em G A C D G
 Where do we go, where do we go now, where do we go
 Em G A C D G
 Where do we go, where do we go now, oh where do we go now
 Em G A C D G
 Where do we go, sweet child, where do we go now
 Em G A C D G
 Aih, aih, aih, aih, aih, aih, aih, oh where do we go now
 Em G A C D G
 Where do we go, ohhhhh, where do we go now
 Em G A C D G
 Where do we goooooo, where do we go now
 Em G A (Fill) Em
 Where do we goooo, ohhh where do we go now, now-now-now-now-now-now-now
 (Em) G A C D E
 Sweet child, sweet chiiiiiiiiiiiild of mine

[Fill]

eb

Bb

Gb

Db

Ab

Eb

|-----|

|-----|

|-----|

| -9--7-----|

| -7--5--9--8--7--5--|

| -----7--6--5--3--|

\

3

/\

3

/